

FROST PROTECTION

If you are planning year-round crops or just want to get ahead in spring, some kind of frost protection is essential.

Not everyone has access to a greenhouse, but there are plenty of other solutions.

CONTROL YOUR CLIMATE

Cold frames and cloches (see right) are ideal for use when your seedlings are young and at their most vulnerable. They help to maintain a constant temperature for your crops, and at the same time provide protection from pests such as birds, mice, and insects. If you are sowing into modules indoors before planting out, keep crops in a cold frame until they harden up before transferring them into the ground. Ensure your cold frame is well-insulated and can be partially opened to provide good ventilation. Before sowing seed into the ground, cover the soil with a cloche to warm it beforehand, then place a cloche over the plant to help to maintain a constant temperature while the seeds are germinating. You can improvise a cheap and easy cloche by cutting a plastic bottle

in half and using the top part to cover a seed or young plant.

Unscrew the lid to ventilate.

For larger areas of crops, create your own polytunnel by stretching plastic wrap or horticultural fleece over wire or plastic hoops, and pinning down securely.



Protect your plants with a cold frame.



Recycle to create your own cloches.